

ENGLISH LANGUAGE PAPER 4

PART A Group Interaction

Below is an extract from an online article about using your own mobile device at school:

Bring Your Own Device

One high school in Virginia, USA, is considering a program that allows students to bring their mobile devices including smartphones, iPads or notebook computers to school. The program would be rolled out slowly over two semesters giving teachers and students time to adjust to the change in policy.

“For our older students there is a policy right now of not using mobile devices, so we will have to have that debate about when it will be appropriate,” said Jean Colley, a senior staff member of the school.

For the first semester, “Bring Your Own Device” will be implemented only in select classrooms where teachers have volunteered to test the program before it is introduced school-wide during the second semester.

Board Chairman Garry Carter said he hopes the program will be implemented carefully and that other methods of learning that have been so successful for so long will not be abandoned. Colley stressed that the devices would not take the place of traditional teaching with pencils and books.

“I don’t think you’ll see a classroom of students doing this,” Colley said bowing her head with thumbs moving as if tapping out a text message. “But I do think these devices will accelerate their learning.”

School Board member Anne Rollins said it is important the students learn to filter and synthesize the material they get online. “The technology is going to give them data, but it’s not going to think for them.”

In your group discuss the possibility of introducing a “Bring Your Own Device” policy in your school. You may want to talk about:

- the benefits and problems of this policy
- how to prevent such problems
- in which subjects mobile devices would be most useful for students
- anything else you think is important

PART B Individual Response

1. Do you have a mobile device?
2. Do you take a mobile device to school?
3. Do you use a mobile device to do your homework?
4. Do students use mobile devices for learning in your school?
5. If your school offered to buy you a mobile device, what would you choose?
6. Do you think a mobile device helps you learn faster?
7. Do you think you can improve your English using a mobile device?
8. How will mobile devices change the way people learn?